



MONTHLY UPDATE

Mauritius: monthly update, July – August 2026

Edition of 2026-08-28 · 45 systems and instruments tracked

Developments summarised from sources published between the beginning of last month and today.

SUMMARY OF THE MONTH · GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · GEOPOLITICS

Summary of the month

The month's substance is one document and one event. The omnibus bill introduced on 24 July to execute the 2026-2027 budget amends 58 Acts and creates the statutory frames for fintech governance, artificial intelligence, virtual-asset marketing, digital immigration and compulsory cyber threat-sharing — a legislative volume larger than any standalone technology act on the continent, arriving as a finance instrument. The state operator's summit on 16 and 17 July produced a cable commitment, a hyperscaler memorandum and a compute claim; reporting since has established what is contracted behind each.

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

At the summit on [16 July the ICT minister committed the government to a National Data Governance Strategy](#) covering cybersecurity, privacy and children's online safety, with no text or date stated.

Legislation and regulation

The [omnibus introduced on 24 July 2026](#) runs to 119 pages, amends 58 Acts and repeals one, commencing in stages from 1 September 2026. A [secondary account put the figure at some sixty laws](#); the enacting text gives the exact count.

The same bill redraws the virtual-asset perimeter around marketing rather than activity: unlicensed solicitation would be prohibited by any medium, reaching targeted advertising, platforms, social media, influencers, affiliates and referral codes, with any publicly accessible communication presumed to target Mauritius — which puts the burden on an offshore promoter to show it was not soliciting locally.

And on [30 July the ICT minister committed to Electronic Transactions Act amendments](#), with no text or date stated.

The primary text of the [Data Protection Officer Regulations 2026](#) is now held, as Government Notice No. 117 of 2026 made under the Data Protection Act.

Data protection

The Data Protection Act 2017 is not among the Acts the July omnibus amends: the digital provisions sit in five Acts and the safeguards Act is not one. At the same summit the ICT minister also committed to Data Protection Act amendments covering cybersecurity, privacy and children's online safety, with no text or date stated. Communications interception, run without judicial oversight, has no drafted narrative this period.

Regional collaboration

The continental internet registry seated here is still without a settled board. One outlet's analysis records that the registry [named a person to all eight board seats on 12 September 2025 while withholding every candidate vote tally its own election guidelines promised](#), and that the appeal court has now [set aside its 2023 appeal for want of corporate authority without ruling on the official receiver's permission or on statutory leave](#). The chain from election through appointment to quorum is therefore unresolved and the receiver undischarged. No registry statement on the withheld tallies is held.

Standards

And the model-as-a-service work billed as a telecom first was [announced on 20 July](#) as work to define conformance criteria for a framework that does not yet exist.

Public debate and participation in policymaking

The month's sharpest domestic contribution was an argument about priority. A [named analyst published on 2 August](#) the case that contract enforcement rather than technology limits growth, citing the World Bank's 2025 indicators — 42.2 on ease of commercial dispute resolution against Singapore's 73.3 — and more than 70,000 cases pending at end-2025. Its digital prescription is digitalised case management alongside a small-claims process. Analysis, not evidence.

The month's other forum was external in origin. At the national Internet Governance Forum, founded by the Halley Movement, the [Blockchain for Good Alliance and the exchange Bybit met the Vice President and the ICT minister](#) to discuss artificial intelligence, cybersecurity and digital-trust frameworks for small island developing states. The record held is the visiting alliance's own press release; no forum programme, outcome document or attendance figure is held.

Finance

Domestic budget appropriations and expenditure

The 2026-2027 budget's tax and revenue measures as enacted are not held. Three fetch paths into the [National Assembly's bills library](#) returned an HTML shell rather than the 128-page Finance Bill: the library is script-rendered and exposes no static file path, so acquiring it needs a browser rather than an automated fetch. Nothing in this window changed that.

New investments

A United Nations development agency published its [country annual report for 2025](#), held in full. It is the agency's own account of its year rather than an independent evaluation, and the digital component is not separately costed in it, so no figure can be lifted from it for this section. What it gives the base is the shape of one external programme against which domestic appropriations can be read.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

The Prime Minister announced on [16 July 2026](#) that [Mauritius will join the America-India Connect subsea cable programme](#). Reporting on [2 August](#) established [what sits behind it](#): a signed non-disclosure agreement, terms still under negotiation, no published timetable. The driver is ageing infrastructure — LION and LION2 still carry most international traffic — and the same account notes that Google already operates a ground station at Baie-du-Jacotet serviced by the state operator, so the cable would deepen a relationship rather than open one.

An industry survey put the 5G record on file for the first time: service since July 2021, when the state incumbent opened what the survey calls Africa's first 5G experience zones on spectrum assigned directly to the three operators, [reaching 86 per cent of the population in 2025](#) with take-up projected to move from 9 to 44 per cent. It is delivered mainly as home internet boxes and in shopping centres, business districts and the university.

Data Storage

At the regional summit on 17 August the prime minister announced [a carrier-neutral green data centre and a "Digital Embassy Village"](#) as the digital leg of a bid to position the country as a regional hub and gateway. No site, capacity, cost, operator or date is stated, which is what separates it from the two data centres already running.

Energy

Cabinet also [approved for signature a memorandum with Saudi Arabia](#) putting digital transformation and energy-sector cybersecurity alongside hydrocarbons — an approval to sign, not a signature, with no date, term, value or committed system stated.

Cybersecurity

Two cyber measures moved. The [July omnibus would empower the central bank to establish a cyber threat intelligence sharing platform](#) and to require financial institutions, and others it specifies, to participate — the clearest instance of mandatory threat-intelligence sharing in primary legislation on this record. At a [workshop on 29 July](#) the postal operator began being wired into the Universal Postal Union's global postal threat-sharing centre, with the ICT minister naming ISO/IEC 27001 as the standard he wants adopted.

August supplied the first figure for what any of this is against: [more than 4,000 reported cyber incidents in Mauritius since January 2026](#), given at the launch of the schools awareness programme. No reporting body, definition or comparable earlier period is named with it.

The ministry's own communique put [4,076 cybersecurity and online-behaviour reports between January and July 2026 against a cybercrime unit of seventeen investigators](#). Both figures come from the same communique, which is what makes the ratio quotable.

The instrument behind the blocking figures is now held, and it settles how they are counted. [Telecommunication Directive 2 of 2025](#), issued on [24 March 2025](#) under the ICT Act, moved the four internet service licence holders off the regulator's centralised child-sexual-abuse filter and onto on-premises filtering in each operator's own network against the Project Arachnid blacklist by 1 May 2025, with no deep packet inspection, HTTPS blocking only at domain level, monthly returns of access attempts and blocked addresses and domains, and an annual external security audit. The blocked-attempt totals the base carries are therefore hit counts against a list, not unique users and not confirmed retrievals.

DPI

Data Exchange

The companion [Finance Bill, before Parliament from 27 July](#), widens what the statistics office may share with the finance ministry and imposes new declaration duties on public bodies — the state's data plumbing rewritten alongside its tax code, with no matching amendment to the Data Protection Act.

Digital Identity and CRVS

The same omnibus also makes immigration permits issuable in digital form and imposes a digital travel authorisation on visa-exempt arrivals.

Digital Payments and Fintech

The [omnibus bill of 24 July](#) puts the National Fintech Governance Committee on a statutory footing from 1 September 2026 — minister-chaired, seating the central bank governor, the financial regulator's chief executive, two ministries, the investment board and four private-sector members, empowered to approve sector-wide standards, and expressly not a body corporate. It was announced with the [fintech strategy on 25 June](#) and reached statute within a month.

On cross-border payments the state operator [announced a Mauritius-Seychelles corridor as a launch](#); no corroborating record from the partner fintech or either central bank is on file. A [South African Reserve Bank spokesperson said on 29 July that Mauritius is among four states considering onboarding to the Southern African settlement system](#) by end-2027 — another central bank's account of Mauritian intent.

Sectoral management information systems

Two sector information systems sit at opposite ends of the same problem this window. A validation workshop [endorsed a proposal for a national Fisheries Information System, for submission under a multilateral fisheries fund's project-implementation grant window](#) — a system that does not exist yet and has no award behind it. Meanwhile the health estate shows what happens after a system is built: patients discharged from a national centre [were reported still looking for their medical records](#), against a one-patient-one-record ambition. The base holds no delivery figure for either.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

The same omnibus also gives clinical trials a statutory electronic licensing system, with the procedure written into the same Act as the channel.

A smaller service went live rather than being provided for. On 18 August the transport and IT ministries [launched an online motor vehicle licence system letting taxi operators renew the licence and pay road tax without visiting a post office or a land transport counter](#), which the ministry says will also build a database of operators, alongside a website for the operators' welfare fund — 6,567 registered members of 7,802 operators, with about 3,000 already on an electronic platform. The authority's underlying system is stated as outdated and a tender has been launched to upgrade it; no transaction volume, cost or extension beyond taxi operators is published.

A smaller service is being taken online with its own figures attached: commercial-weighting oversight, which [verified 12,412 measuring instruments across 4,971 businesses and inspected 4,974 shops in 2025-2026, is moving bookings, payments and certificates onto a new platform](#). No go-live date or cost is stated.

Cabinet [took note of a plan to consolidate the government portal and the separate official websites into a single citizen-centred platform](#). Taking note is not approval, and no budget, supplier or delivery date accompanies it.

Technology

AI

The [AI Registry](#) went live on 9 July 2026, a week before the summit that showcased it: a directory of Mauritius-relevant models, agents and skills carrying provider identity and any institutional validation, which does not host or sell what it lists. The stack is open-sourced and is being offered to other operators.

The [same keynote recorded a retreat](#): the schools pilot moved from a student tutor to a teacher assistant after teacher and parent resistance.

The month closed with the state's AI apparatus being measured from outside it. On 27 July the [chamber of commerce and two partners launched an adoption, readiness and governance study](#), because there is no clear picture of adoption among Mauritian firms or of what skills exist. The AI City Scheme has no drafted narrative this period.

The incumbent operator set out what sits behind that directory. Its chief executive described [a cloud partnership with a hyperscaler, sovereign data centres, a plan to train 50,000 people in artificial-intelligence skills, and a voice model built for Mauritian Creole](#), putting the education platform's exam-marking tools at 99% accuracy across the tools introduced. The figures and the claim of a first are the operator's own, given in an interview.

ICT Industry

The ICT minister [put information technology at about 5.4% of gross domestic product against an ambition of 10-12%](#). The two accounts name different third partners.

Capacity

Training and skills

The incumbent operator opened a national cybersecurity and artificial-intelligence awareness programme for secondary students with the education ministry, [starting on 13 August at the Mahatma Gandhi Institute with about 500 Grade 10 to Grade 12 students drawn from all four education zones](#), and free ten-hour AWS training on offer alongside. A [companion account of the same workshop](#) describes its content as online risk and responsible use of new technologies. It is an operator-run programme rather than a curriculum change, and no full-year target, budget or evaluation is stated.

Geopolitics

US / hyperscaler activities

The summit's other announcements differ in kind. The [Amazon memorandum was executed at the opening ceremony](#) with soft scope and no disclosed value, and [its training will run initially in rented premises](#). The claim that the operator's data centre already hosts current-generation accelerators is the chief executive's own.

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